SOURCE: MEPC.264(68).pdf
instruments (MSC.1/Circ.1455).
Refer to the annex to HELCOM Recommendation 25/7, Safety of Winter Navigation in the Baltic Sea Area, available at www.helcom.fi
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4.4 If there is not full and direct compliance, then an equivalent level of risk can be accepted in accordance with guidance provided by the Organization. An increase in the probability of an event can be balanced by a reduction in its consequences. Alternatively, a reduction in probability could potentially allow acceptance of more serious consequences. Using a hull area example, a local shortfall in strength level or material grade could be accepted if the internal compartment is a void space, for which local damage will not put the overall safety of the ship at risk or lead to any release of pollutants.

4.5 For existing ships, service experience can assist in risk assessment. As an example, for an existing ship with a record of polar ice operations a shortfall in the extent of the ice belt

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SOURCE: MEPC.264(68).pdf
4.5 For existing ships, service experience can assist in risk assessment. As an example, for an existing ship with a record of polar ice operations a shortfall in the extent of the ice belt (hull areas) may be acceptable if there is no record of damage to the deficient area; i.e. a ship that would generally meet PC 5 requirements but in limited areas is only PC 7 could still be considered as a category A, PC 5 ship. In all such cases, the ship's documentation should make clear the nature and scope of any deficiencies.

4.6 The process includes the following stages of assessment:

.1 select the target Polar Class for equivalency;

.2 compare materials used in the design with minimum requirements under the IACS Polar Class URs; identify any shortfalls; and

.3 compare strength levels of hull and machinery components design with requirements under the IACS Polar Class URs; quantify levels of compliance.

Where gaps in compliance are identified in steps 1 to 3, additional steps should be necessary to demonstrate equivalency, as outlined below:

.4 identify any risk mitigation measures incorporated in the design of the ship

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SOURCE: MEPC.264(68).pdf
Where gaps in compliance are identified in steps 1 to 3, additional steps should be necessary to demonstrate equivalency, as outlined below:

.4 identify any risk mitigation measures incorporated in the design of the ship (over and above the requirements of the Code and IACS URs);

.5 where applicable, provide documentation of service experience of existing ships, in conditions relevant to the target ice class for equivalency; and

.6 undertake an assessment, taking into account information from steps 1 to 5, as applicable, and the principles outlined in paragraphs 4.2 to 4.6 above.

4.7 Documentation provided with an application for equivalency should identify each stage that has been undertaken, and sufficient supporting information to validate assessments.

4.8 Where a ship in categories A or B is provided with an equivalency for ice class by its flag State, this should be noted in its Polar Ship Certificate.

5 A dditional guidance to chapter 4 (Subdivision and stability)

No additional guidance

6 Additional guidance to chapter 5 (Watertight and weathertight integrity)

No additional guidance.

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SOURCE: MEPC.264(68).pdf
5 A dditional guidance to chapter 4 (Subdivision and stability)

No additional guidance

6 Additional guidance to chapter 5 (Watertight and weathertight integrity)

No additional guidance.

7 Additional guidance to chapter 6 (Machinery installations)

Refer to additional guidance to chapter 3.

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8 Additional guidance to chapter 7 (Fire safety/protection)

No additional guidance.

9 Additional guidance to chapter 8 (Life-saving appliances and arrangements)

9.1 Sample personal survival equipment

When considering resources to be included with the personal survival equipment, the following should be taken into account:

Suggested equipment
Protective clothing (hat, gloves, socks, face and neck protection, etc.)
Skin protection cream
Thermal protective aid

Sunglasses
Whistle
Drinking mug
Penknife
Polar survival guidance
Emergency food
Carrying bag

9.2 Sample group survival equipment

When considering resources to be included in the group survival equipment, the following should be taken into account:

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SOURCE: MEPC.264(68).pdf
Drinking mug
Penknife
Polar survival guidance
Emergency food
Carrying bag

9.2 Sample group survival equipment

When considering resources to be included in the group survival equipment, the following should be taken into account:

Suggested equipment
Shelter tents or storm shelters or equivalent sufficient for maximum number of persons
Thermal protective aids or similar sufficient for maximum number of persons
Sleeping bags sufficient for at least one between two persons
Foam sleeping mats or similar sufficient for at least one between two persons
Shovels at least 2
Sanitation (e.g. toilet paper)
Stove and fuel sufficient for maximum number of persons ashore and maximum anticipated time of rescue
Emergency food sufficient for maximum number of persons ashore and maximum anticipated time of rescue
Flashlights one per shelter
Waterproof and windproof matches two boxes per shelter
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Suggested equipment
Whistle
Signal mirror
Water containers & water purification tablets
Spare set of personal survival equipment

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SOURCE: MEPC.264(68).pdf

Suggested equipment
Whistle
Signal mirror
Water containers & water purification tablets
Spare set of personal survival equipment
Group survival equipment container (waterproof and floatable)

10 Additional guidance to chapter 9 (Safety of navigation)

10.1 Radars equipped with enhanced ice detection capability should be promoted to be used, in particular in shallow waters.

10.2 As the chart coverage of polar waters in many areas may not currently be adequate for coastal navigation, navigational officers should:

.1 exercise care to plan and monitor their voyage accordingly, taking due account of the information and guidance in the appropriate nautical publications;

.2 be familiar with the status of hydrographic surveys and the availability and